

- **Tables:** Tables can be inserted, too. Make sure you modify the table properties and set the table width to relative, with values of 80 per cent or 90 per cent.
- **Images:** Images add spice to the otherwise monotonous text of an Ebook. The cover image is by far the most important one—it helps readers distinguish a book in their Ebook library. The recommended size for cover images is 590x750 pixels at 72 DPI or better. Images can be in the JPEG or PNG format. For images in your text, make sure they are resized, and are inserted in their 'original size'. In the *Crop* tab in *Picture Properties*, check the box to keep picture in their original size. In the *Options* tab, enter *Alternate Text* for your image; this goes into the alt attribute of the XHTML `<IMG/>` element. You might find it convenient to resize images within 30 per cent of the page width, and align them to the left, with text flowing to the right. Feel free to experiment and choose what works best for you and your Ebook software.
- **Generating HTML:** Once you have completed composing your work in OO Writer, use the 'Save As' option to save it as HTML, which is anything but XHTML 1.1-compliant; hence, there's one more step that converts the HTML to XHTML 1.1 before you are ready to move on to the final stage of producing your EPUB Ebook.
- **Converting to XHTML:** Conversion from HTML to XHTML is easy, thanks to the nice folks who have written *html2xhtml*, a neat tool for precisely this purpose. The website (see References) also provides an option to convert documents online. Assuming that you have downloaded, compiled, and installed this tool—and believe me, this is the better option while experimenting—you can use the following command for the conversion:

```
$ html2xhtml -t 1.1 <input_file> -o <output_file>
```

- **XHTML validation:** Once you have your XHTML 1.1 source, test it in your browser, to check if the styling and layout appear as you intended them to. It might be necessary to tweak the XHTML manually to ensure the text flows around a graphic. Finally, validate your XHTML 1.1 using the W3 Markup Validation Service (see References). The result should be nothing short of an unqualified *Pass* with the *DocType* as XHTML 1.1, and *Encoding* as *UTF-8*! If you do not get a *Pass*, or if the *DocType* and *Encoding* are not detected correctly, it is better to iron things out before you proceed further.

Calibre

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formats, convert them from one format to another, push Ebooks to major Ebook Reader devices, and manage your collection of Ebooks. However, as we agreed earlier, we are going to stick to the straight and the narrow path, and use an almost default subset of Calibre features, which are adequate to produce our Ebook.

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Producing your Ebook

Let's return to our task, after the brief digression of getting to know Calibre. We now have our book source as validated XHTML 1.1 with any accompanying images, all in one folder. Click 'Add Books' in Calibre, and add the XHTML 1.1 source file to Calibre, which, on its part, collects the XHTML and associated images, and zips them into a folder. It should now appear as a new entry in the list on the Calibre home screen. You are now ready for the final step of converting your content to EPUB. Select the newly added entry, and click the 'Convert E-books' button to start the conversion process.

Populating the metadata

The conversion window pops up, showing the metadata entry form. Enter the name of the book, its author, the tags denoting content or the genre and a brief summary of the book. An important field is the *Author Sort* field. If you want authors sorted by their last name in your Ebook library list, then you should re-enter the author's name in the *Author Sort* field in the 'last-name, first-name' format. You can also upload the cover image that you had prepared earlier. If you do not upload a cover image and leave all cover-related settings at their default settings, Calibre automatically generates a default cover for your book.

Detecting structure

Most other aspects of conversion, such as 'Look & Feel', 'Structure Detection' etc., are best left at their default values; nothing needs to be done with them. However, there is work to be done on the *Table of Contents* screen. Normally, Calibre auto-detects the chapters in a document, using a sophisticated XPath expression that looks for the words 'Chapter', 'Part', 'Book' or the class='chapter' attribute. So, if all your chapter titles have any of these words, you have nothing to worry about. However, to make chapter detection more generic, open the *Table of Contents* screen, and enter `//h:h1` and `//h:h2` as the XPath expressions for Level 1 TOC and Level